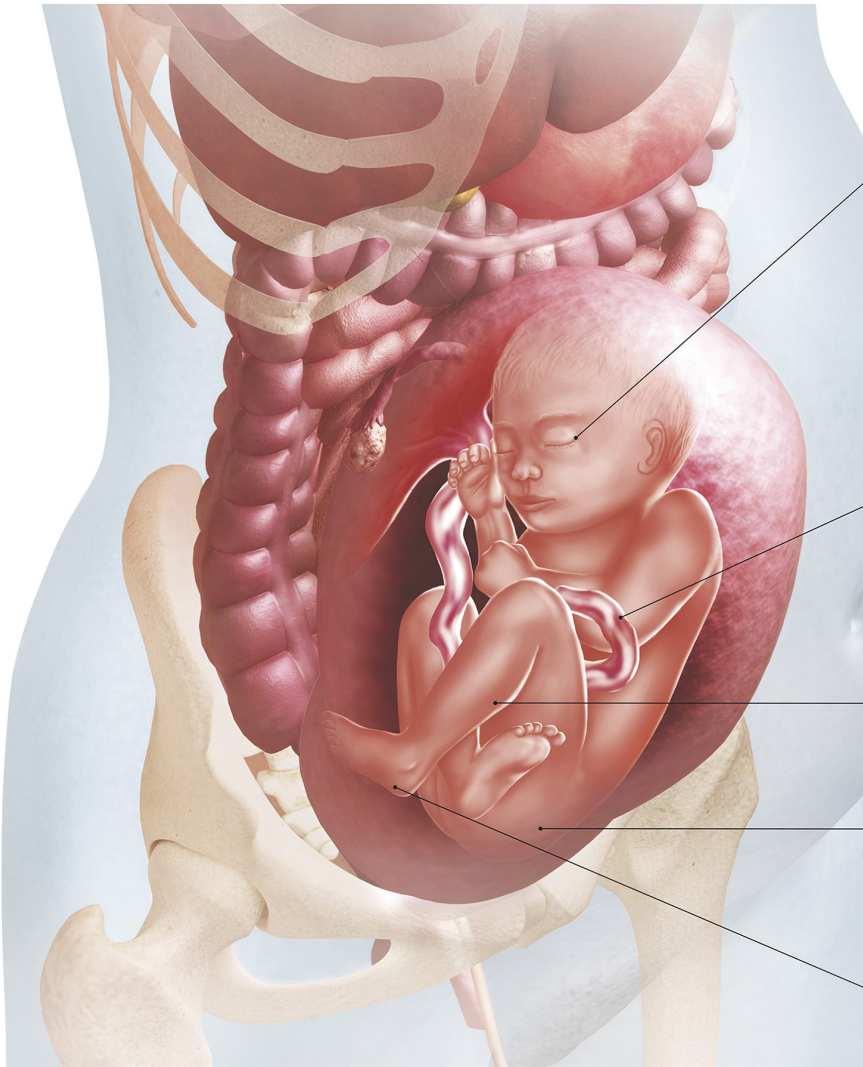




The baby spends much of his time asleep. Like children and adults, babies have a sleep pattern that includes a "dreaming" stage, when rapid eye movements (REM) can be recorded.

The blood in the umbilical cord contains stem cells, which have the ability to develop into specific body cells such as those forming blood, or brain, or muscle tissues.

The legs may be crossed or even curled up on top of the head at times but there is still space for them to be stretched out fully.

Some 25 percent of babies are lying bottom first at this stage. Most of them turn before the end of pregnancy.

At 31 weeks the average crown to heel length is 16.2 in (41.1 cm) and the average weight is 3.3 lb (1.5 kg).